

Town of Westhampton
Town Hall
1 South Road
Westhampton, MA 01027

Finance Committee Meeting Minutes
Tuesday, July 29, 2014

The meeting convened at 7:05 PM

Present:

Finance Committee Members: Ellice Gonzalez, Jackie Brodeur, Mary Cleary, Thomas Cleary, Jr., Maryanne Duggan, Aniko Giordano, Margaret Parsons, Celeste Whiting. Cheryl Provost, Administrative Assistant.

1. Correspondence—various mail items handed out.
2. Reviewed the minutes of June 10, 2014. Voted 8-0-0 to accept the minutes.
3. Old Business: We discussed the meeting with Roland Chaffee (Town Accountant), Todd Ford (Administrator of HCOG), Anne Marie Knox (Town Treasurer) and the Selectboard. The town has entered into a three-month contract with the current accountant for the months of July, August, and September. We discussed the town's need for accuracy in town accounts and warrants and the options available to the town in ensuring account accuracy. FinCom will draft a memo on the current accounting issues.

We noted the status of Free Cash certification. The books must be closed and the Free Cash certified by September.

4. New Business: We noted the number of transfers that are required this year to balance the books. We noted the FinCom should schedule a meeting to be posted and held after the closing of Town Meeting and before the closing of the fiscal year.

We voted to make all of the year-end appropriation transfers 8-0-0.

Margie presented the Cherry Sheets. We reviewed the Cherry Sheets and the Recapitulation sheet and FY 2015 budget.

We discussed the role of the Finance Committee, the budget process and the guidelines for FY16. Ellice presented the committee with copies of The Role of the Finance Committee from the Association of Town Finance Committees' Handbook. We discussed our role of reviewing departmental budgets, meeting with department heads, presenting a balanced budget at town meeting and educating the town and departments regarding the budget.

To that end, we assigned tasks to help make the budget process for FY16 a smoother and more successful process.

- Ellice will draft a letter to departments regarding the budget requests and the calendar for such requests.

- Mary and Aniko will review last year's budget process and note the areas of success and areas in need of improvement. This review will be used to generate guidance for the budget process for the coming year.

- Celeste will survey other towns to gather info on how they manage Free Cash and capital planning.

In the future we will address facilitating meetings between departments for budgeting and capital planning.

Our next meeting will take place on Tuesday, September 23, 2014 at 7:00pm.

We adjourned at 8:40.

Respectfully Submitted by Mary Cleary